

Pandora and Proxychains

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Background

- Pandora doesn't work outside the states
- I keep forgetting how to set-up `proxychains`

Proxychains

Technically this article [expects proxychains-ng](#), which seems to be the more up-to-date fork of the original `proxychains`.

1. Install `proxychains-ng`

```
# I am on archlinux..  
sudo pacman -S proxychains-ng
```

2. Copy the configuration to the `$HOME` directory

```
cp /etc/proxychains.conf .
```

3. Edit said configuration to add some US-based proxy

In my particular case, I don't keep the tor section enabled.

```
tail $HOME/proxychains.conf
```

```
#  
#      proxy types: http, socks4, socks5  
#      ( auth types supported: "basic"-http  "user/pass"-socks )  
#  
[ProxyList]  
# add proxy here ...  
# meanwhile  
# defaults set to "tor"  
# socks4      127.0.0.1 9050
```

I actually use [Windscribe](#) for my VPN needs, and they have a neat [SOCKS5 proxy setup](#). This works out to a line like `socks5 $IP $PORT $USERNAME $PASS` being added. The default generator gives you a pretty server name, but to get the IP I use `ping $SERVER` and put that in the `conf` file. Any online DNS resolver will also do the trick, like [this one](#).

****Note****

The SOCKS5 proxy from Windscribe has been [phased out](<https://windscribe.com/knowledge-base/articles/why-was-socks5-discontinued>) but it is actually easier to do this via the [proxy gateway](<https://windscribe.com/features/proxy-gateway>) and split tunneling.

For inclusive split tunneling, add the following (minimally):

```
tuner.pandora.com
audio-usc-mp1-t1-2-v4v6.pandora.com
```

At some point it might be nice to actually have this done via a WireGuard configuration to cut out the app in the middle..

Pandora

I use the excellent `pianobar` frontend.

1. Get `pianobar`

```
sudo pacman -S pianobar
```

2. Use it with `proxychains`

```
proxychains pianobar
```

3. Profit

I also like setting up some defaults to make life easier:

```
mkdir -p ~/.config/pianobar
vim ~/.config/pianobar/config
```

I normally set the following (inspired by the [ArchWiki](#)):

```
audio_quality = {high, medium, low}
autostart_station = $ID
password = "$PASS"
user = "$emailID"
```

The `autostart_station ID` can be obtained by inspecting the terminal output during an initial run. I usually set it to the QuickMix station.